

update_readme_doc_links

scripts/testing/ update_readme_doc_links.sh — README Tracked-Items table regenerator

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-08-21T19:45:00Z **Purpose:**
§11.4.57 machine-derived regenerator for README.md's ###
Tracked-Items + Status Documents table. **Last verified:** 2026-08-21

Overview

README.md carries a ### Tracked-Items + Status Documents table (bounded by <!-- doc-link-section:begin --> / <!-- doc-link-section:end --> markers) that is the mandated entry point (§11.4.57 / §11.4.212) for every tracker and status document in this repository. Each row's Last modified and Revision cells are supposed to be sourced verbatim from the document's own §11.4.44 revision header, and the HTML / PDF cells are supposed to reflect whether those exports actually exist on disk.

Before this script existed, that table was hand-maintained, and it had drifted: measured 2026-08-21 (BOB-088), 10 of its 18 rows carried a stale Revision/Last modified pair (e.g. docs/Issues.md carried **Revision:** 38 while the table still read 10), two rows read – (not yet exported) for HTML/PDF cells that had real exports on disk, and one MANDATED document (docs/GOVERNANCE_AUDIT_2026-08-08_ROUND2.md, cited by name in BOB-088's own body text) had no row at all.

Usage

```
scripts/testing/update_readme_doc_links.sh          # rewrite
               README.md in place
scripts/testing/update_readme_doc_links.sh --check   # read-
               only; exit 0 = in sync, exit 2 = stale
scripts/testing/update_readme_doc_links.sh --check --readme
               <path> # override target (tests)
```

Default mode rewrites README.md in place. --check mode is read-only and prints a unified diff of the stale rows before exiting 2 — safe to wire into a pre-commit or pre-build sweep.

This script does not regenerate README.html/.pdf/.docx. Run scripts/generate_markdown_exports.sh afterward (§11.4.65/§11.4.12) so the exports stay in sync with the source it just edited.

Scope (deliberately narrow)

This generator owns only the closed-set “Tracked-Items” row class §11.4.57 names: Issues/Fixed + their _Summary companions, CONTINUATION, PORTING-FROM-LAVA, REMAINING_WORK_PLAN, every docs/GOVERNANCE_AUDIT_*.md (auto-discovered via git ls-files, so a third round audit doc is picked up automatically), COMPLETION_STATUS, RELEASE_READINESS_20260616, QA_DISCOVERY_LEDGER, and every docs/**/Status.md + its Status_Summary.md (and RELEASE_READINESS.md sibling, if present) pair, likewise auto-discovered.

§11.4.212’s broader “every §11.4.65-scope doc must be reachable from README, directly or transitively” obligation is a distinct, editorial-judgement- bearing task (which subsection a guide/research doc/plan belongs under) and is handled separately in README.md’s other ### subsections — this generator does not attempt it, to avoid silently mis-categorizing a doc it has no basis to categorize (§11.4.6).

Internal behavior

1. Builds a manifest of label|relative-path pairs: a fixed list plus two auto-discovered classes (docs/GOVERNANCE_AUDIT_*.md, docs/**/Status.md pairs).
2. For each manifest entry, reads ****Revision:**** / ****Last modified:**** straight out of the file’s own header (§11.4.44) — a document with no header emits – for both cells, never a fabricated value.
3. Checks `[[ -f ... ]]` for the .html and .pdf siblings on THIS run — never carried forward from the table’s previous state.
4. Replaces only the table portion of the content between the doc-link-section markers; the hand-authored intro paragraph

above the table, and anything after the table but before the end marker, are left untouched.

A fixed defect worth knowing about (BOB-088, 2026-08-21)

The first version of the block-rewrite awk state machine dropped only the old table's header line and its `|---` separator, then fell through to printing every old data row unchanged — so applying the generator to a genuinely stale table produced **two back-to-back copies** of the table instead of replacing it. Caught by a RED-first regression test (`tests/unit/test_update_readme_doc_links_no_duplication.sh`, run against the pre-fix script and confirmed to fail 3/5 assertions before the fix, then pass 5/5 after) before it ever shipped in a commit.

Testing

- `tests/unit/test_update_readme_doc_links_no_duplication.sh` — regression guard for the table-duplication defect above; drives the real script through its real invocation path against a fixture whose Issues row carries a deliberately stale Revision, and asserts (1) exactly one Issues row survives the rewrite, (2) the stale value was corrected to the real live value read off `docs/Issues.md`, (3) content after the table block is preserved, (4) the end marker is not duplicated, (5) a second run is idempotent.

Dependencies

bash 4+, git, sed, grep, awk. No Python, no network access.

Cross-references

- `README.md` — the file this script rewrites.
- `CLAUDE.md / constitution/CLAUDE.md §11.4.57` — the mandate this script implements (README doc-link section + revision metadata).
- `CLAUDE.md / constitution/CLAUDE.md §11.4.212` — README as the canonical documentation entry point (the broader obligation this script does NOT attempt; see “Scope” above).
- `scripts/generate_markdown_exports.sh` — must be run afterward to keep `README.html/.pdf/.docx` in sync.
- BOB-088 — the tracked workable item this script closes.